TASK 4: FIFTH-WHEEL, TRAILER AND WHEEL-SECURITY INSPECTION

Heavy Vehicle Service and Maintenance Technician Level 3 | Block 3 | v1.1

TIME
90 minutes (adapt to workplace conditions)

EVIDENCE
Practical | Knowledge | Documentation

PROGRAMME POINT
Weeks 27-42 | Months 7-11

Your task

Inspect a tractor/trailer coupling, trailer chassis and wheel-security system, then record defects and explain the controls required before coupling, uncoupling or returning the combination to service.

What you must do

1. Confirm compatibility, vehicle/trailer identity and safe uncoupling arrangements.
2. Inspect fifth wheel, kingpin, locking mechanism, mounting and safety devices.
3. Inspect trailer chassis, landing legs, connections, wheels, fixings and indicators.
4. Measure or verify relevant wear limits, torque procedures and functional checks.
5. Record defects, serviceability decision and required action.

What good evidence looks like

SAFE CONTROL
Keep clear of the coupling crush zone; support the trailer correctly and use the specified wheel-fixing procedure and full torque.

CORRECT METHOD
A logical sequence using current manufacturer, DVSA, company and task-specific information.

ACCURATE EVIDENCE
Actual values, test conditions, units, findings and evidence references recorded clearly.

SOUND DECISIONS
A justified serviceability, repair, referral or recovery decision followed by appropriate verification.

You will need

- Tractor and trailer or coupling rig
- Torque data and wear gauges
- Chocks, support and coupling inspection tools
- DVSA/manufacturer information and PPE

SOW ALIGNMENT

Block 3 - Chassis, Steering, Suspension, Wheels, Tyres and Trailers

KSB evidence focus: K2, S7, S8; reinforced K1, K3-K6, K10, S1, S3-S10, B2-B3

Task reference: HV_L3_Block_3_Task_4_Fifth_Wheel_Trailer_and_Wheel_Security_Inspection

TASK 4: FIFTH-WHEEL, TRAILER AND WHEEL-SECURITY INSPECTION

Practical record

Apprentice, location and vehicle details

Apprentice name

Date

Employer / training centre

Vehicle / trailer make and model

Registration / fleet number

Odometer / hours

VIN / chassis / trailer number

Job card / task reference

Measurements and technical checks

Fifth-wheel / kingpin wear		Wear limit	
Lock / safety-device check		Landing-leg / chassis check	
Wheel-fixing condition		Torque procedure / value	
Connection / compatibility		Decision / defect reference	

Special tools, equipment, calibration or technical-information requirements

Task evidence

PPE, precautions and safe-system controls used

Safety-critical findings and immediate action

Work completed, actual findings, diagnosis, recommendations and verification

Knowledge check

1. Why must the trailer be secured before uncoupling?

2. How is correct fifth-wheel engagement verified?

Knowledge check - continued

3. Explain why wheel fixings require a controlled tightening sequence.

4. What defects require the combination to remain out of service?

5. What evidence should be retained after the inspection?

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation

- [ ] Secures tractor/trailer and controls coupling hazards.
- [ ] Inspects locking, mounting and safety devices.
- [ ] Checks trailer chassis, landing legs and connections.
- [ ] Applies wheel-security and torque information correctly.
- [ ] Makes and records a justified serviceability decision.

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation notes

Decision and feedback

Decision - select one

- [ ] PASS
- [ ] REFER

Evidence reference

Feedback and action required

Sign-off

Signatures confirm that this is the apprentice's own work and that the evidence and developmental decision are accurate.

Apprentice name

Assessor/Workplace Mentor name

Apprentice signature

Assessor/Workplace Mentor signature

Date

Heavy Vehicle Level 3

Task answer continuation | Form accessibility revision 12 November 2026

Use this page when an answer will not fit visibly in its original box.
Reference the question and write "See continuation page" in the original answer.
Keep each response within the visible space. Add another copy of this page if needed.

Apprentice name

Block / task / page number

Question / section reference

Continued answer

Question / section reference

Continued answer

Continuation evidence must be reviewed with the original task and referenced at sign-off.